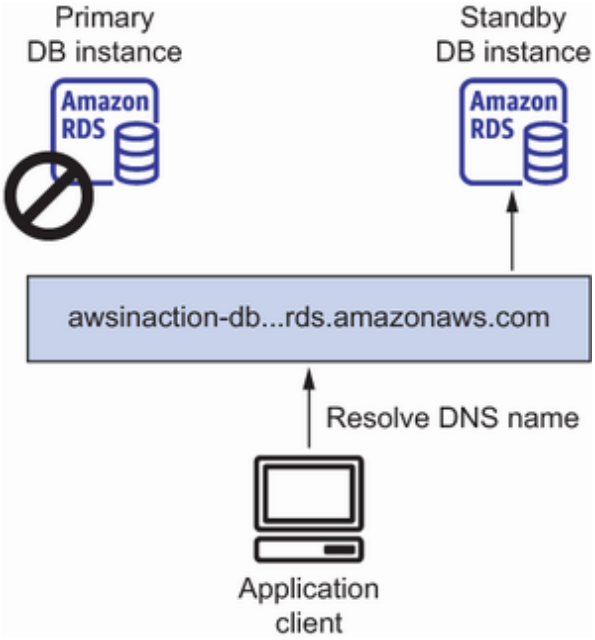


Figure 10.6 The client fails over to the standby database if the primary database fails, using DNS resolution.

Aurora is different

Aurora is an exception to the way that highly available databases operate in AWS. It does not store your data on a single EBS volume. Instead, Aurora stores data on a cluster volume. A cluster volume consists of multiple disks, with each disk having a copy of the cluster data. This implies that the storage layer of Aurora is not a single point of failure. But still, only the primary Aurora database instance accepts write requests. If the primary goes down, it is automatically re-created, which typically takes less than 10 minutes. If you have replica instances in your Aurora cluster, a replica is promoted to be the new primary instance, which usually takes around one minute and is much faster than primary re-creation.